

HAPPINESS MASCOTS (From left) Palash Vaswani, director, *Gullak* S2 & S3; Jaidev Singh, Head (Security & Safety), DHL Express India; Nadeem Khan, Regional HR Manager (North & East India), DHL Express India; Rohit Choudhary, Director, The Akshaya Patra Foundation; Dr Shahid Iqbal Choudhary, IAS, Jammu and Kashmir; Raj Chengappa, Group Editorial Director (Publishing), India Today; Sri Bharatarshabha Dasa, National President & Trustee, The Akshaya Patra Foundation; Anant Goenka, MD, CEAT Limited; Gaur Gopal Das, lifestyle coach and motivational speaker; Dr Sahar Qureshi, Medical Superintendent, Max Smart Super Speciality Hospital, Saket, Delhi; Surender Kumar, Goa government; Vijay Koshy, President, TVF; Shreyansh Pandey, Head, TVF Originals; Jameel Khan, actor, *Gullak*; Ahsaas Channa, actress, *Kota Factory*; Arunabh Kumar, Founder, TVF

INDIA TODAY RPG Happiness Quest

Celebrating *Joyfulness*

After nine months of showcasing life lessons from exemplary individuals and companies, INDIA TODAY awards those who spread joy through their work

By **SHWWETA PUNJ**

Happiness is not the first thought that crosses your mind when you look back at the past two years. In fact, we could re-christen the pandemic era as a famine of happiness. But every renunciatory period must be broken, every fast must be followed by a period of replenishment—emotional, physical and spiritual. As a magazine, INDIA TODAY had already chosen to respond to the darkness with light. For the last nine months, we ran a campaign of positivity in mission mode—every week, we showcased life lessons from the exemplary work being done by individuals and companies. On April 9, a balmy summer evening in Delhi, we brought it to a grand finale. Outside was rush-hour traffic and the infinite mess of everyday life. But inside the verdant Sunder Nursery, on stage were lined up all the mascots of happiness. These were people who possess what might even be imagined as a form of magic—except that they weave it out of the most ordinary fibre. Through thought, word, and action.

Take Jubin Nautiyal, for instance. With his melodious voice and soulful music, the 32-year-old playback singer and performer has been hitting all